

Maine governor to run for Senate

Democrat Mills eyes seat held by GOP's Collins

By James Pindell and Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

Janet Mills, the Democratic governor of Maine, is planning to announce Tuesday that she will join the race to challenge Republican Senator Susan Collins, setting up a potentially fierce contest between two long-time forces in Maine politics that could significantly affect the balance of power in Washington.

Two sources with direct knowledge of Mills's plans confirmed she would enter the nationally watched contest. The governor called Democratic senators this week to inform them, one of the sources said.

Mills, 77, has been active in Maine politics for much of her life. She was elected governor in 2018, easily defeating a Republican opponent and reclaiming the office for Democrats after eight years of Republican Paul LePage. In 2022, Mills stifled LePage's comeback bid, defeating him by more than 12 points to win a second term. She is unable to seek a third term under Maine law.

A center-left Democrat, Mills has occasionally clashed with progressives in the state Legislature, but this year, she made national headlines for her high-profile clashes with President

MAINE, Page A10

Foe of Maduro gets Nobel for peace

By Julie Turkewitz, Jonathan Wolfe, and Thomas Fuller

NEW YORK TIMES

María Corina Machado, the Venezuelan opposition leader who built a powerful social movement and became the most significant threat and detested adversary to the country's long-standing authoritarian regime, was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize on Friday.

A conservative former member of the National Assembly, Machado has been a driving force in opposing a quarter century of socialist rule that has grown increasingly repressive under President Nicolás Maduro. She has been living in hiding since last year, when Maduro cracked down on the opposition after claiming victory in an election that was widely seen by independent analysts as fraudulent.

The Norwegian Nobel Committee praised Machado for her "tireless work promoting democratic rights for the people of Venezuela and for her struggle to achieve a just and peaceful transition from dictatorship to democracy."

Machado has largely avoided

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ALFREDO LASRY R/GETTY IMAGES/FILE

María Corina Machado gestured to supporters in July 2024.

'The premise of the document is inconsistent with our core belief that scientific funding should be based on scientific merit alone.'

SALLY KORNBLOTH, MIT president

MIT rejects Trump 'compact'

Kornbluth says university's practices 'meet or exceed' White House demands

By Diti Kohli

GLOBE STAFF

Just over one week after the Trump administration stepped up its push to reshape higher education, sending nine prominent universities a lengthy list of demands, the Massachusetts In-

stitute of Technology became the first to say, effectively, "No thanks."

In a letter Friday to Education Secretary Linda McMahon, MIT president Sally Kornbluth said the school's practices already "meet or exceed" the ad-

ministration's requested provisions for merit-based admissions and financial aid, and that the university disagrees with other demands that restrict academic freedom and institutional independence in exchange for federal dollars.

"We freely choose these values because they're right, and we live by them because they support our mission — work of im-

mense value to the prosperity, competitiveness, health and security of the United States," Kornbluth wrote. "And of course, MIT abides by the law."

"The premise of the document," Kornbluth continued, "is inconsistent with our core belief that scientific funding should be based on scientific merit alone."

It marks academia's clearest

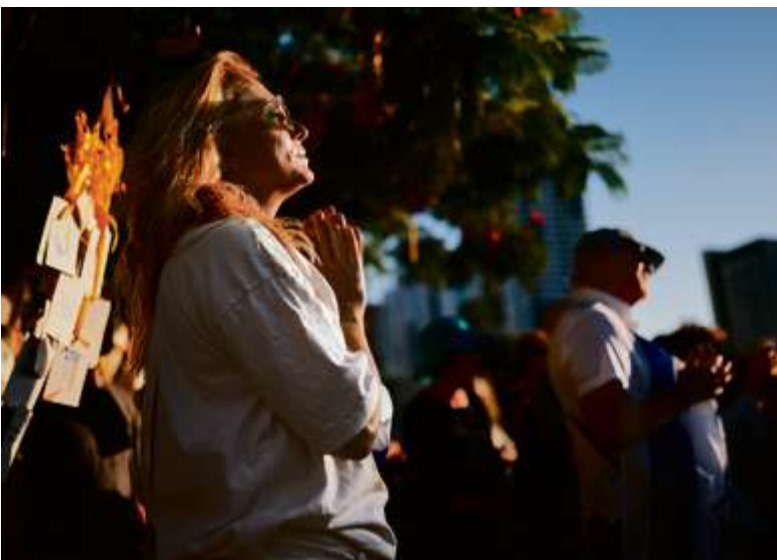
MIT, Page A7

A CEASE-FIRE AND A CELEBRATION

Thousands of people began the long walk from the south to the north of the Gaza Strip on Friday after the Israeli military announced a cease-fire that mediators hoped would lead to the end of the two-year war. In Tel Aviv (bottom), people celebrated the promised release of the hostages as they marked the Jewish holiday of Sukkot. A spokesperson said the UN was negotiating with Israeli authorities to increase the volume and frequency of aid going into Gaza. **A3.**



SAHER ALGHORRA/NEW YORK TIMES



FRANCISCO SECO/ASSOCIATED PRESS



ARIEL SCHALIT/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A new challenge on the Charles: a toxic bacteria outbreak as famed regatta nears

By Sabrina Shankman

GLOBE STAFF

It's October in Boston, and on the Charles River that means one thing: Rowers are getting ready for the Head of the Charles.

The iconic regatta begins in a week, but this year, as rowers prepare to battle it out, it's not just other boats they'll be dodging on the water — it's toxic blooms of cyanobacteria, too, which are made worse by ongoing heat and extreme rains.

For 10 weeks, parts of the Charles River — as well as waterways around the state — have been found to have above the safe limit of the blue-green algae, which can cause skin rashes and eye irritation upon contact.

If ingested, even a small amount can lead to gastroin-

testinal symptoms, and large amounts can cause liver or neurological damage. If it's windy or the bacteria gets stirred up, inhalation can cause respiratory irritation and exacerbate preexisting respiratory conditions.

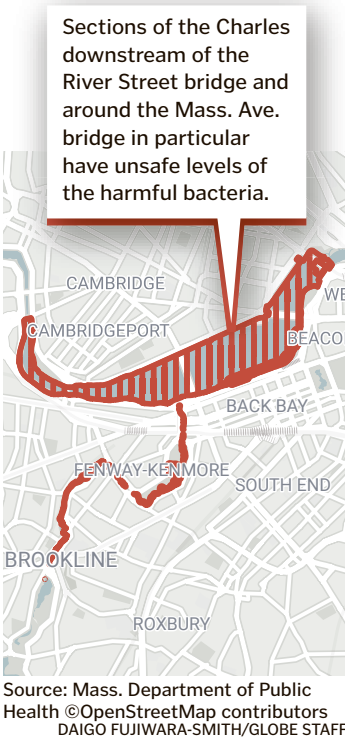
"If there's a lot of cyanobacteria, people are like, 'I don't really want to go down there, because — ew,'" said Karen Chenausky, president of the Riverside Boat Club.

It can show up in different ways, appearing like spilled blue or green paint, or like swirling colors beneath the surface of the water.

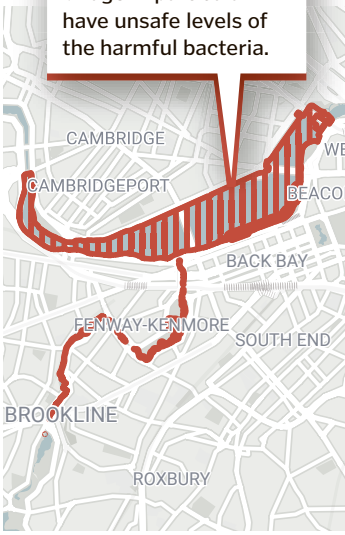
One of the rowers at the club, Andy O'Brien, said he noticed the bloom settle in late August.

"This year's outbreak is probably one of the worst in

CHARLES, Page A10



Sections of the Charles downstream of the River Street bridge and around the Mass. Ave. bridge in particular have unsafe levels of the harmful bacteria.



Source: Mass. Department of Public Health © OpenStreetMap contributors DAIGO FUJIWARA-SMITH/GLOBE STAFF

Shutdown pain

The White House began another round of layoffs targeting federal workers, as Governor Maura Healey criticized the administration for suggesting that furloughed workers will not be guaranteed back pay. **A2, B1.**

The Las Vegas Aces won their third WNBA championship in four seasons, beating the Phoenix Mercury, 97-86. **C1.**

A blast leveled an explosives plant in rural Tennessee, leaving at least 19 people missing and feared dead, authorities said. **A2.**

A strong nor'easter off the Carolina coast will head up the East Coast and straight into New England this holiday weekend. **B1.**

Vermont-based sporting goods outfitter Orvis is closing 31 stores and five outlets nationwide. **D1.**



Sunning out of time

Saturday: Sun then clouds, High: 62-67. Low: 53-58.

Sunday: Getting rainy. High: 60-65. Low: 53-58.

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

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